

RICHMOND ESSIEKU

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EDUCATION

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX

Ph.D. in Economics

Expected June 2026

University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV), Edinburg, TX

M.S. in Applied Statistics and Data Science

August 2022

Xiamen University, Xiamen, China

M.A. in Applied Economics

May 2019

University of Cape Coast, Cape Coast, Ghana

B.S. in Economics with Mathematics

May 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Health and Labor Economics, Public Policy, Household Finance, Data Science

JOB MARKET PAPER

Diagnosed too Soon or too Late? Labor Market and Health Outcomes of Adults with Early vs. Late ADHD Diagnosis

This paper investigates whether, among the ADHD-diagnosed population, the timing of diagnosis affects adult labor market and health outcomes across demographics lines. Using nationally representative data from the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS), we estimate these effects by addressing both selection on observables and unobservables through an Average Treatment Effect (ATE) framework, employing Inverse Probability Weighting (IPW), Propensity Score Matching (PSM), Double Machine Learning (DML), and an Instrumental Variable (IV). Our results show that early diagnosis leads to substantial improvements in adult health, including reduced activity limitations, better mental health, and lower healthcare expenditures. However, these health gains do not translate into higher earnings. Despite working more hours, early diagnosed individuals earn less than those diagnosed later, suggesting persistent barriers to accessing high-quality employment. These findings highlight a disconnect between health and economic outcomes and emphasized the need for integrated policy approaches that combine clinical treatment with educational and labor market supports.

DISSERTATION CHAPTERS

- [1] **Chapter 1 (JMP):** Diagnosed too Soon or too Late? Labor Market and Health Outcomes of Adults with Early vs. Late ADHD Diagnosis
- [2] **Chapter 2:** Labor Market Margins and the Affordable Care Act's Health Insurance Reforms: Racial Heterogeneity Among Pre-Retirees
- [2] **Chapter 3:** Labor Market Effects, Mortality Penalties, and the Obesity–Diabetes Double Burden: Evidence from NHIS Mortality Data Using Machine Learning

PUBLICATIONS

Submitted Papers

- [1] Multiple Job Holding and Functional Health Outcomes Across Demographic Lines. Submitted to **Economics Letters** (Elsevier).
- [2] Who Benefits from Residential Solar? Evidence on Energy Insecurity Disparities and Policy Gaps in the U.S. Submitted to **Economics Letters** (Elsevier).
- [3] Buy Now, Struggle Later? Generational Differences in BNPL Use and Household Financial Behaviors. Submitted to **Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics** (Elsevier).
Co-author: Prince Bosompem

- [4] When Assistance Isn't Enough: Energy Insecurity Among Older Adults and Policy Consideration in Energy Assistance Programs. Submitted to **Journal of Aging and Social Policy** (Taylor and Francis).
- [5] Fear and Anger in Public Reactions to Mpox on Instagram: Implications for Health Policy and Communication. Submitted to **Journal of Health Communication** (Taylor and Francis).
Co-authors: Ama Quansah, Helena Baffoe, Solomon Eshun
Role: Second Author
- [6] Human or AI? Who do Financial App Users Trust for Market Forecasts? Submitted to **Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics** (Elsevier).
Co-authors: Prince Bosompem, Prof. Gary Mottola
- [7] Whose Advice Do We Trust? Social Network Sources and the Divergence of Confidence in AI vs. Human Experts in Housing Investment. Submitted to **Finance Letters** (Elsevier).
Co-author: Prince Bosompem

Working Papers

- [1] Locked In or Left Behind? The Impact of Non-Compete Agreements on Job Mobility and Career Advancement in the U.S. Labor Market. Co-author: Dr. Kaj Gittings
- [2] Machine Learning and Significance Analysis of Microarray (SAM) Based Methods for Predicting Obesity of Hypothalamic Pituitary Adrenal (HPA) Axis. Co-authors: Dr. Rodrigo Hansapani, Dr. Vincent Diego
- [3] Pre-Retirement Labor Supply and Health Coverage Access: Racial Gaps in the Health Insurance Marketplace.

Published Works

- [1] Eshun, S., **Essieku, R.**, and Ladzekpo, J. (2023). Stability analyses on the effect of vaccination and contact tracing in monkeypox virus transmission. *Journal of Mathematical and Computational Science*, 13, Article-ID.
- [2] **Essieku, R.**, Baffoe, H., Akatu, M. K., Bosompim, P., and Ladzekpo, J. (2024). Machine Learning Feature Selection Techniques to Model the Elements of Cash Conversion Cycle and Other Covariates on Hospital Performance. In *Research Updates in Mathematics and Computer Science*, Vol. 8, 29–47. <https://doi.org/10.9734/bpi/rumcs/v8/440> (Book Chapter)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE/ASSISTANTSHIP

Texas Tech University, Department of Economics, Lubbock, TX

ECO - 4322-001: The Economics of Labor Markets (Assisted)	Spring 2025
ECO - 2302-101: Principles of Economics II: Macroeconomics (Assisted)	Summer 2024
ECO - 3311-002: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Assisted)	Fall 2022, Spring 2024
ECO - 2305-008: Principles of Economics (Assisted)	Fall 2023
ECO - 3312-001: Intermediate Economic Theory (Assisted)	Spring 2023

UTRGV, School of Mathematical & Statistical Sciences, Edinburg, TX

MATH 1314: College Algebra (Instructed)	Spring 2021
STAT 2334: Applied Statistics for Health (Assisted)	Fall 2021
MATH 1460: Calculus I (Assisted)	Summer 2021
MATH 1301: Statistics and Mathematics - Jump Start (Instructed)	Summer 2022

Mathematics and Science Academy, Edinburg, TX

MATH 1343: Intro to Biostatistics (Assisted)	Spring 2022
MATH 2412: Pre - Calculus (Assisted)	Spring 2022

Regional Maritime University, Port and Shipping Department, Accra, Ghana

BLM 105, BPS 105, DPS 105: Element of Economics I (Assisted)	Semester 2 2016
BLM 201, BPS 201, DPS 201: Element of Economics II (Instructed)	Semester 1 2017
BLM 101, BPS 101, DPS 101: Mathematics - Algebra with Analysis (Assisted and Instructed)	Semester 1, 2017, 2020

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ghana Revenue Authority, Accra-Tema, Ghana

Junior Statistician and Analyst

November 2015 – July 2016

- Produced high-frequency statistical reports on revenue mobilization and public finance operations, applying economic reasoning to inform tax policy and compliance monitoring.
- Conducted data-driven evaluations of taxpayer behavior and revenue trends contributing to internal auditing processes and econometric insights for decision support.

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Peer Reviewer – Academic Journals and Conferences

2023 – 2025

- Completed 15 invited peer reviews for academic journals and conference proceedings, including: International Economics and Economic Policy (Springer), Journal of Data Analysis and Information Processing (JDAIP), Journal of Service Science and Management, iBusiness, Southwest Decision Science Institute (SWDSI), IntelliSys Conference (2024–2025), and IACMR Conference (2025).

Academic Judge – Student Research and Presentation Competitions

2023 – 2025

- Served as judge and committee member for multiple academic competitions at Texas Tech University, including: 3-Minute Thesis Competition (2023–2024), Art and Humanities Conference (2023–2024), Undergraduate Research Competition (2025), and TTU Graduate Poster Research Competition (2024).

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

- Oral and Poster presenter at academic conferences, including: SEA 95th Annual Meeting (2025, scheduled), ASSA Annual Meeting (2026, scheduled), World Obesity and Weight Management Congress (2024), Obesity Research Institute Annual Conference (2023, 2024), College of Sciences Research Conference – UTRGV (2024), West Texas Health Disparities Symposium – TTU (2024), Graduate Student Research Poster Competition – TTU (2023, 2024).

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Academic Scholarships and Fellowships

- Helen Devitt Jones Fellowship Grant, Texas Tech University2022–Present
- Graduate Assistantship, Department of Economics, Texas Tech University2022–Present
- Graduate Assistantship, Department of Mathematics and Statistics, UTRGV2021–2023
- Chinese Government Council Scholarship2017–2019
- HEERF Grant, State of Texas2021

Research and Competition Awards

- First Place, 22nd Texas Tech Graduate Student Research Poster Presentation
- First Place, Kaggle Data Mining Competition (Team won over 11 competing teams)

COMPUTER SKILLS

• R • Python • SAS • STATA • LaTeX

REFERENCES

Dr. Kaj Gittings, Associate Professor Texas Tech University Department of Economics kaj.gittings@ttu.edu	Dr. Hansapani Rodrigo, Professor University of Texas Rio Grande Valley Mathematical and Statistical Sciences hansapani.rodrigo@utrgv.edu	Dr. George Yanev, Professor University of Texas Rio Grande Valley Mathematical and Statistical Sciences george.yanev@utrgv.edu
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